

Akshat Bhaskar

Student-Researcher & Social Innovator · Mathematics, Economics & Public Policy

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PROFILE

Student-researcher and social innovator from New Delhi working across economics, artificial intelligence policy, and pure mathematics. One of seventeen students nationwide felicitated by the President of India for work on AI under the Government of India's SOAR initiative. Peer-reviewed AI policy researcher under a University of Pennsylvania professor, and Chief Financial Officer of TaxCity, a financial-literacy initiative that has reached 79,000+ students across 27 countries. Founded the India Chapter of the Edunomix Institute, a US 501(c)(3) nonprofit, and studies advanced number theory as a Lodha Genius Programme scholar at Ashoka University (3.2% acceptance).

EDUCATION

Delhi Public School, R.K. Puram

New Delhi, India · Senior Secondary (CBSE), Class of 2026 · Apr 2022–May 2026

- Relevant Coursework: Physics, Chemistry, Mathematics, Economics, and English
- President Student Council of one of India's most competitive schools, leading over 9500+ students.

Selective Academic Programmes & Fellowships

Lodha Genius Programme · Pure Mathematics

Ashoka University, Sonipat · ~3.2% acceptance, fully funded & residential · May–Jun 2025

- Completed university-level coursework in Number Theory, Group Theory, Linear Algebra, and Geometry.
- Attended the invitation-only Great Ideas Seminars alongside Nobel laureates Sir Paul Nurse (Physiology, 2001) and Prof. Brian Schmidt (Physics, 2011), and AMS Steele Prize winner Prof. Haruzo Hida (UCLA).

Shadow the Scientists Programme

University of California, Santa Cruz · Remote · Aug–Nov 2025

- Selected for a competitive programme pairing students with active UCSC researchers, under Dr. K Vijay Raghavan (former Principal Scientific Adviser to the Government of India) and Prof. Raja GuhaThakurta (Distinguished Professor of Astronomy and Astrophysics, UCSC).

HKBU Summer School: ESG & Culture in Marketing

Hong Kong Baptist University, Hong Kong · Jun 2025

- Studied under Prof. Barry Hung, Department of Management, Marketing and Information Systems; Nominated as 1 of 5 students from a school of 5,000+.
- **buildspace, s3 Cohort** · Selected from 32,000+ applicants worldwide, May–Sep 2024
- **Eureka! Juniors, E-Cell IIT Bombay** · Entrepreneurship development programme; developed and pitched FinKid, 2024
- **LaunchX, MIT** · Admitted to the main entrepreneurship programme, 2025
- **The Knowledge Society (TKS)** · Admitted to the global innovation programme, 2025

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Teaching Assistant & Research Apprentice · Lodha Genius Mathematics Undergraduate Research Apprenticeship

Ashoka University, Sonipat · 15 May–20 Jun 2026

- Paid research and teaching appointment (INR 10,000 stipend); the programme made an explicit exception to admit a pre-undergraduate participant.
- Conducted original research in advanced number theory under Professor Shanta Laishram, Head of the Theoretical Statistics and Mathematics (Stat-Math) Unit at the Indian Statistical Institute (ISI), Delhi.
- Taught undergraduate-level courses as teaching assistant alongside faculty from UC Davis, IIT Delhi, CMI, ISI Kolkata, ISI Delhi, and Ashoka University.

AI Policy Researcher · University of Pennsylvania

Under Prof. Surbhi Goel, Magerman Term Assistant Professor of CIS · Since Jan 2025

- Researched the socio-economic and governance dimensions of artificial intelligence.
- Produced “The Two Faces of Progress,” peer-reviewed and published in IJRASET; presented the findings at the National Youth Conference on STEM as the only high-school student selected to present.

Quantitative Policy Intern · Ministry of Education, Government of India

Office of Mr. Rahul Pachori, Director · New Delhi · Jun 2025

- Contributed to internal policy analysis of the Samagra Shiksha Scheme, India’s flagship integrated school-education programme under NEP 2020.
- Reviewed financial architecture, inter-ministerial budget flows, and fund utilisation.

Chief Financial Officer · TaxCity Education

New Delhi · Government of India, Ministry of Education-recognised · Since Jun 2024

- Lead finance and grants for a financial-literacy initiative built around a card game that teaches tax filing.
- Secured \$120,000+ in grant funding and contributed to INR 550,000+ in revenue; reached 79,000+ students across 30+ schools in 14 states and 27 countries, spanning 7 curricula.
- Oversee financial planning, budgeting, and grant strategy; supervise a team of finance interns; received letters of recommendation from Members of Parliament.

Founder & President · Edunomix Institute, India Chapter

US 501(c)(3) Nonprofit, first South Asia chapter · Since 2023

- Founded the chapter before turning 16.
- Ran a nationwide essay competition spanning 19 states and 54 schools; organised financial-literacy workshops and events; taught displaced Ukrainian students online.
- Authored and published financial-literacy research; received international recognition from the Edunomix Institute (USA).

Researcher & Writer · Edunomix Institute

Since Dec 2023

- Wrote long-form articles on economics, finance, and public policy for students and educators worldwide, spanning the Union Budget 2024, the Open Network for Digital Commerce, the Bangladesh crisis, sustainable finance, and the economics of private aviation.

Junior Researcher · The Junior Academy, New York Academy of Sciences

Fall 2025 Cohort, ~10% acceptance · Aug 2025–Jul 2026

- Selected into an international research programme drawing high-school students from 100+ countries into interdisciplinary teams.
- Completed the Fall 2025 Challenge on energy infrastructure under Dr. Nandhini Sivakumar, Postdoctoral Research Scientist in Neurodegenerative Diseases at the Motor Neuron Center, Columbia University, developing science-backed policy and engineering proposals.

Founder & Host · Decoded Podcast

Spotify · Apple Podcasts · Amazon Music · Since Dec 2024

- Independent production, no sponsors: outreach, research, interviewing, editing, and distribution.
- Interviews economists, technologists, and policymakers to make economics and technology accessible without jargon.

Selected Delegate & Grantee · Y Combinator Startup School India

Bengaluru · ~8% acceptance, 2,000 founders nationwide · Apr 2026

- Pitched Edunomix, and FinKid directly to Jared Friedman, Managing Director at Y Combinator; received a \$25,000+ AI and cloud compute grant.
- Met the founding teams of Zepto, Razorpay, Groww, and Meesho.

PROJECTS

Limit Order Book & Matching Engine

C++20 · 2026

- Built a high-performance limit order book and exchange matching engine implementing price-time priority, FIFO order queues, limit and market orders, order cancellation, and partial and multi-level fills.
- Designed strongly typed financial primitives for prices, quantities, order IDs, and sequencing; validated with 50+ unit tests covering matching, execution, cancellation, and edge cases.
- Modular architecture with deterministic execution semantics, a clean CMake build system, and benchmark infrastructure for evaluating performance.

mc_pricing · Monte Carlo Options Pricing Library

Python · GitHub · 2026

- Independent project applying Monte Carlo simulation methods to price options contracts in Python.
- Built as a technical portfolio piece ahead of quantitative trading recruiting.

FinKid · Gamified Financial Literacy App

Concept & Prototype · 2023–2024

- Duolingo-style app teaching personal finance to children aged 8 to 14 in India.
- National Finalist, IIT Bombay Action Plan '23; advanced to the National Round of IIT Bombay's Eureka!; developed through the Eureka! Juniors entrepreneurship programme.
- Pitched directly to Jared Friedman (Y Combinator) alongside TaxCity and Edunomix at Y Combinator Startup School India.

LEADERSHIP & ACTIVITIES

President, Student Council

Delhi Public School, R.K. Puram · 9,500+ students · Since Jul 2025

- Elected after a seven-stage selection process of applications, interviews, and faculty recommendations.
- Sworn into office by Shri V. K. Shunglu, ninth Comptroller and Auditor General of India and Vice Chairman of the Delhi Public School Society.
- Represent the student body and coordinate between students, faculty, and school leadership; oversee student-led committees.

Captain, U-19 Football Team

Delhi Public School, R.K. Puram · Jul 2025–May 2026

- Led training, match preparation, and on-field strategy.
- Won the Delhi District Championship twice; represented the district at the Delhi State Championship.

Honorary President & Treasurer, Quizzing Club

Delhi Public School, R.K. Puram · Jun 2024–May 2026

- Managed finances and the sponsorship portfolio, securing \$20,000+ in sponsorships and prizes from PlayStation, Art of Problem Solving, Masters' Union, Taskade, and Crossword.
- Won first place at Quizzonomics (ComAstitva 2024) and ComQuest (Arthashastra 2025); contributed to the school's Overall Rolling Trophy at Comonomics 3.0.

- Offered the elected club presidency; named Honorary President instead, since school policy bars the sitting Student Council President from a second elected post.

Member, Student Council (Class XI)

Delhi Public School, R.K. Puram · Apr 2024–May 2025

- Appointed after applications and interviews; sworn into office by Ms. Namita Pradhan, former Assistant Director-General of the World Health Organisation and IAS officer (1977 batch).
- The role led to election as Student Council President the following year.

Organiser, Daydream Delhi @ IIT Delhi

Hack Club · Oct 2025

- Organised a two-day game jam for high-schoolers at IIT Delhi, part of Hack Club's global Daydream event held simultaneously across 100 cities.
- Featured workshops on Godot and Ren'Py, lightning talks, and a 48-hour game-building sprint, free of charge.
- **Volunteer, Familial Forestry** · Community reforestation movement recognised by the UN Land for Life Award; 5 years; working to open a school chapter

RESEARCH & PUBLICATIONS

Financial Misinformation on Indian Social Media: Multilingual Detection and the Traits That Predict Sharing

Indian School of Business, under faculty mentorship · In progress, 2026

- Multilingual, code-mixed detection pipeline built on MuRIL and XLM-RoBERTa rather than English-only models.
- Paired with the BFI-2-XS personality inventory and the Fear of Missing Out (FoMO) scale to identify which individual traits predict sharing behaviour, not only which posts are false.

“The Two Faces of Progress: A Look at the Socio-Economic Challenges and Opportunities Presented by Artificial Intelligence”

IJRASET, Vol. 13, Issue 7, 2025 · Peer-reviewed & published internationally · DOI: 10.22214/ijraset.2025.73146

- Research on AI policy and existential risk under Professor Surbhi Goel (University of Pennsylvania).
- Presented at the National Youth Conference on STEM, where Akshat was the only high-school student in the room.

“How Economics Runs the World”

Arbitrage: Finance & Investment Journal, IIM Rohtak · Published, 2024

- Analysis of global economic structures, monetary policy transmission, regulatory architecture, and capital market dynamics, with proposed improvements to international financial governance.
- Only high-school author published in the journal.

Financial Economics & Systemic Risk: Black Swan Events

Indian School of Business and Finance, under Prof. Kritika Soni · 2024–Dec 2025

- Research into the propagation of extreme, low-probability, high-impact shocks across global markets, modelling systemic contagion and cross-market spillover through historical crises and tail-risk frameworks.
- Culminated in a first-author research paper.

NEP 2020 Impact Research

Independent study · Discontinued

- Studied the effect of India's National Education Policy 2020 on graduate employability, skill development, and the transition of the labour market, focused on vocational and higher-education pathways.

AWARDS & HONORS

34 honours, 2022–2026, including one felicitation by the Head of State.

Felicitated by the President of India

Rashtrapati Bhavan, New Delhi · SOAR Initiative, Government of India · Jan 2026

- One of 17 students nationwide felicitated by President Droupadi Murmu for work on artificial intelligence and financial literacy.

Further Honours & Distinctions

- **Lodha Genius Programme** · Full-ride selection, ~3% acceptance · Lodha Foundation & Ashoka University, 2025
- **LaunchX, Massachusetts Institute of Technology** · Admitted to the main entrepreneurship programme, 2025
- **Research Publication, IJRASET** · “The Two Faces of Progress,” peer-reviewed & published internationally, 2025
- **MVPP Scholar · Rank 44 of 67,000+** · Top 0.06% statewide · Directorate of Education, Delhi, 2023
- **The Knowledge Society (TKS)** · Admitted to the global innovation programme, 2025
- **Team Captain, Wharton Global Youth Investment Competition** · The Wharton School, University of Pennsylvania, 2025
- **Indian Olympiad Qualifier in Mathematics (IOQM)** · National Merit List and Regional Merit List · Mathematics Teachers’ Association (India), 2025
- **National Space Innovation Challenge** · Atal Innovation Mission (NITI Aayog) in collaboration with ISRO, 2023
- **Top 1%, Pivotal International Essay Competition** · Global Priorities Institute, University of Oxford, 2023
- **Research Presented, National Youth Conference on STEM** · Only high-schooler in the room, 2025
- **National Winner, Masters’ Union Startup Weekend** · “CycleCare,” 1st nationwide before a jury of CXOs, 2023
- **Accelerate Pre-College Program, Northeastern University** · Admitted, with a USD 500 merit scholarship, 2025
- **Featured by the Lodha Group & Lodha Foundation** · Profiled before a combined audience of 500,000+, 2025
- **Finalist, Northeastern University International Essay Competition** · On the economic and social effects of AI on the global economy, 2025
- **Winner, Quizzonomics, ComAstitva** · National economics quiz championship, 30+ schools, 2024
- **1st Prize, ComQuest, Arthashastra & Confest** · DPS Vasant Kunj, contested across Delhi NCR, 2025
- **Overall Rolling Trophy, Comonomics 3.0** · Mount Carmel School, Dwarka, representing DPS R.K. Puram, 2025
- **FinKid · IIT Bombay, E-Cell** · National Finalist, Action Plan ’23; National Round, Eureka!; completed Eureka! Juniors Skill Development Programme, 2023–24
- **Runner-Up, Volatus UAV Challenge, CelesteCon** · Scalable drone delivery design · Aeross, DPS R.K. Puram, 2024
- **Top 200, TOI Young Rangers Contest** · INR 1,000 award · The Times of India, 2023
- **Recognised by Prof. ShyamSunder Jyani, Familial Forestry** · Community reforestation volunteer, 2024
- **Delhi Zonal / U-17 Football Championship, Winner** · Back-to-back seasons, 2023–24 and 2024–25 · Directorate of Education, Delhi

School Honours · Delhi Public School, R.K. Puram

- **Principal’s Gold Medal for Academic Excellence** · 2023
- **Principal’s Blue Blazer for Academic Excellence** · 2024–25
- **Principal’s Scholar Badge for Academic Excellence** · all years, 2022–25
- **Principal’s Red Tie for National Achievements** · 2024
- **Principal’s Red Pin for National Achievements, Quizzing** · 2024

- **Principal’s Red Pin for National Achievements, Football** · 2024

SELECTED WRITING

Peer-reviewed and journal publications appear under Research & Publications above.

- **“On AI Policy and Existential Risk”** · Pivotal International Essay Competition, Global Priorities Institute, Oxford · Top 1% internationally, 2023
- **“The Economic and Social Effects of Artificial Intelligence on the Global Economy”** · Northeastern University International Essay Competition · Finalist, 2025
- **“Effects of Overvaluation on Competition and the Broader Economic Landscape”** · Edunomix Institute, 2024
- **“India Budget 2024”** · Edunomix Institute, 2024
- **“Unveiling ONDC: Transforming Indian E-Commerce”** · Edunomix Institute, 2024
- **“The Rise of Sustainable Finance”** · Edunomix Institute, 2024
- **“Private Jets and the World Economy”** · Edunomix Institute, 2024
- **“Bangladesh in 2024: What’s Next?”** · Edunomix Institute, 2024

MEDIA & PUBLIC ENGAGEMENT

Decoded · Independent podcast on economics and technology

- Named a 2025 Marathon Show, a 2025 Instant Hit Show, and a 2025 Most Shared Show in Spotify’s Wrapped for Creators; surpassed 300 listening hours on Spotify, produced without external sponsorship.
- **Press Coverage** · The Times of India, The Economic Times, and Dainik Bhaskar
- **LinkedIn** · 7,000+ followers for writing and commentary on economics and policy

SKILLS, LANGUAGES & INTERESTS

Research Interests: Economic Policy, Mathematical Economics, Financial Inclusion, AI Policy, Analytic Number Theory

Technical: Python, LaTeX, HTML/CSS/JS, data analysis, transformer-based NLP (MuRIL, XLM-RoBERTa)

Languages: English (native), Hindi (native)

Interests: Chess, Speedcubing, Financial Literacy Advocacy, Podcast Production, Football